



AFRICAN CONNECTIONS WELCOMES YOU TO EGYPT



Ahlan wa sahan (Welcome in Arabic)

Thank you for choosing African Connections to provide comprehensive tour services for your upcoming “Return to the Motherland, African Heritage Tour” of Egypt scheduled for October 15th - 24th, 2025 (9 nights/ 10 days).

African Connections, “AC” is your Gateway to Africa. We have been a leader in African travel for over 20 years and the entire AC Team is preparing for your upcoming visit to Egypt.

We pride ourselves on delivering outstanding concierge services. We are happy to assist you and provide you with the information you’ll need to prepare for your journey.

When you reach Egypt, we will meet you at the airport when you arrive and assist you throughout your stay in Egypt.

Our team is knowledgeable, professional, and proud to show you the wonders of Egypt, a country we know so well.

This welcome guide will provide you with information that will be helpful as you make your travel preparations.

Please review this information carefully. We welcome your questions and look forward to seeing you in Egypt soon!

Your Tour

You should book your tickets to depart from the USA on October 14th, 2025, and arrive in Egypt on October 15th, 2025.

Your tickets should have you depart from Egypt on October 24th, 2025. Most flights would then have you arrive back in the United States on October 25th, 2025.

Your tour begins when you arrive in Egypt on October 15th and ends when we see you off at the airport on October 24th 2025.

Egypt Travel Requirements

Egypt is a tourist-friendly destination, but you must know travel requirements and have your travel documents ready before your departure date. Please read the following information carefully.



Passports and Visas

A valid passport is required for all international travel. It must be valid for at least six months from the date that you will return to the United States. Check your passport expiration date to be sure it meets this requirement, and if necessary, apply for a renewal as soon as possible. You will not be allowed to board your departure flight if your passport expiration date is within six months of your scheduled return to your home country.

A Visa is required to enter Egypt. However, we will arrange for you to acquire your Visa upon arrival at Cairo Airport. The fee is currently \$25. You will need to have this amount in cash when you arrive in Cairo.

Immunization and Medical Information

Currently, there are no immunization requirements for entry into Egypt.

Prescription Medications:

If you take prescription medication, you are responsible for determining their legality in Egypt and note the following:

- We advise you to bring enough of your medication with you.
- Always keep your medication in the original container.
- Carry a copy of your prescription(s).
- Pack your medicine in your carry-on luggage, not your checked luggage.

Travel Insurance

Travel Insurance is not included in your package. However, it is strongly recommended that you purchase travel insurance to cover any unexpected event that might interrupt or prevent your travel.

Our company offers optional travel insurance through Allianz Global, a leader in the travel insurance field. You can click the link below or visit our website, www.africanconnections-usa.com, to get a quote.

https://www.agentmaxonline.com/agentmaxweb/widgets/quotetool.html?widgetid=859099&ac_cam=F212819&code=ABIYU4TLWGBGTNHC6ZWLRSKAR65GB6C5JLBJOIXR7QY3M6I5HDDHZDIECAM4JHS6KBOBIU5FYWBJM3BAHKTFTOR572B73AM4ZH74ZMNXVK3YLBWT3Z3F4X4R3Z53LEU4



Shopping in Egypt

You will love shopping in Egypt! Whether you are haggling for souvenirs at one of Egypt's traditional local markets, or shopping in one of its modern shops, Egypt has something for everyone!

Whether shopping for Egyptian cotton, Egyptian oils, silver jewelry, papyrus or alabaster, you will find great values, if you haggle.

Bargaining with the locals is not for the faint of heart, as vendors will follow you back to the bus if you show any interest at all so be prepared to walk away and stay firm with your price.

Climate

Egypt's climate is generally dry, hot, and dominated by desert. Daytime temperatures vary by season and change with the prevailing winds. Temperatures vary widely and can range from 32 °F to 109 °F. However, Egypt's weather in October is excellent. In fact, October is one of the best months to travel to Egypt. During your visit to Egypt, the average daytime highs should range around 85°F, and nighttime temperatures should range from 68°F to 77°F.

Clothing and Packing

Bring comfortable outfits. Cotton or other fabrics that breathe will help you stay comfortable. It will be warm in Egypt.

We advise that you bring a light sweater or jacket for evenings and/or early mornings.

Please make sure you take comfortable flat walking shoes as most of the sites have uneven ground, desert sand and rocks. Also take at least one pair with nonslip sole for entering pyramids and tombs. Egypt is not the place for high heels!.

Note: Egypt is a conservative, predominantly Muslim country, so dress modestly and avoid revealing clothing. There will be opportunities to swim at your hotel, so pack your swimsuit, but remember to bring a swim cover too.

Electric outlets in Egypt are 220 volts, while U.S. appliances are 110 volts. So, **most of your U.S. small appliances will not work in Egypt. However, laptops, phone chargers, and other universal devices should work in Egypt.** You might need an adapter for these devices, as the outlets in Egypt differ in shape from those commonly found in the U.S. However, you can buy an adapter when you arrive in Egypt. They are readily available and inexpensive.

Toiletries/Personal Items

Be sure you bring all your toiletries and personal items. While you will have opportunities to



buy such things in Egypt, you might not be able to find the brands you prefer.

Customs Requirements

Passengers' obligations at Egypt Customs are outlined on the **Egypt Revenue Authority** website; see www.eta.gov.eg for details.

When you arrive in Egypt, you will pass through Egypt Customs and might be asked if you have anything to declare. You must declare any commercial goods or currency more than \$10,000 you bring into Egypt.

Money, ATMs, and Credit and Debit Cards

Cash

There is no limit on the amount of money you can bring into Egypt. However, if you bring in more than \$10,000 in cash, you must declare it when you pass through customs on entry. If you bring in less than \$10,000, there is no need to declare any cash that you bring in.

You can exchange your dollars for the local currency during your stay in Egypt.

ATMs

ATMs are readily available, but you will pay an international fee and a local bank fee for ATM transactions, in addition to possibly receiving a lower exchange rate for each transaction.

Credit and Debit Cards

If you intend to use your debit or credit card in Egypt, you should inform your bank that you are traveling to Egypt to prevent a fraud alert or possible block of your card.

Also, note that many businesses that take debit or credit cards use POS equipment that requires a PIN. While we all know our debit card PIN, most people do not have or know their credit card PIN. So, if you intend to use a credit card, contact your bank and make sure you have and know the PIN associated with the card.

Note: Only Visa and Mastercard are accepted in Egypt.

Neither American Express nor Discover Cards are accepted in Egypt.

Domestic Flights

Your tour package includes the airfare for a roundtrip ticket between Cairo and Luxor. Our itinerary's many exciting historical sites are spread over a large area of Egypt, and traveling by bus would take many hours. We have opted to provide you with comfortable and relatively short domestic roundtrip flights between Cairo and Luxor, so you can see all the sites in the Cairo area and then travel comfortably to Luxor to see all the sites spread out along the River Nile too.

Hotels, Restaurants, and Cruise Boat

Hotels

During your Egyptian adventure, you will lodge in top-rated 5-star hotels. Each stay combines modern sophistication with traditional charm, offering premium amenities. In Cairo, we stay at the Steigenberger Hotel, offering breathtaking views of the Pyramids, and in Aswan, we lodge at the Tolip Hotel with its marvelous view of the Nile River.

Cruise Ship

Your tour includes a four-night Nile River Cruise on the luxury Steigenberger Regency. Cruising along the Nile offers an unmatched experience of relaxation and beauty. You will be in a 5-star riverboat with spacious cabins, a sun deck, and sophisticated dining areas, ensuring you can savor the journey in style. While sailing, you will be treated to the timeless scenery of the Nile—graceful palm trees adorning the riverbanks, traditional felucca sailboats gliding past, and the tranquil flow of the water.

We will board the Cruise Ship after we arrive in Luxor and will have four full days to cruise on the Nile, docking at spots along the way that allow us to visit the temples and other historical sites scattered along the banks of the Nile.

Each day on the cruise presents tranquil moments as you witness the sunrise and sunset over the river, with the golden light casting a radiant glow on the surrounding landscapes. Life along the Nile unfolds serenely, providing insight into the daily routines of local communities. Whether unwinding on the deck or dining while enjoying panoramic views, the cruise offers a seamless blend of comfort and breathtaking natural beauty.

Restaurants

We have carefully selected each restaurant you will visit on your tour. These restaurants will provide clean, wholesome food, hygienic conditions, and the choice of tasty local Egyptian dishes or more familiar continental dishes.

Food and Water

Your tour package includes several meals, including all meals (breakfast, lunch, and dinner) while on the Four-Day Cruise.

In the hotels we have a full buffet breakfast each day. Traditional Egyptian food like kofta, kebab sticks, mixed grill, koshari and felafel is readily available and you will never get bored with the choices. There are also plenty of varieties of vegetarian food available.

You will be able to buy meals that are not included in the tour package at restaurants that we have carefully selected. There will be many food choices, and you can sample delicious Egyptian and more familiar dishes. The average cost of a meal with a soft drink and water in Egypt ranges from \$15-\$20.

We will supply you with bottled water each day. It is also available in your hotel rooms. Although the locals all drink tap water it is very heavily chlorinated and is fine for brushing teeth and bathing, but is not recommended for drinking. The hotels, cruise ship and the restaurants that we select for you, all use purified water to make their ice cubes. So you should feel free to add ice cubes to your drinks.

While some of your favorite snacks might be available in Egypt, and we will make regular stops for you to stock up on snacks, fruit, and drinks during the trip, it's a good idea to bring the special snacks you prefer.

Cell Phone/Data Usage and Internet Service:

Although we will have free Wi-Fi access at each hotel, it might be spotty. There is no free Wi-Fi access on board the cruise ship. However, there is a mobile device you can connect to if necessary.

Therefore, before departing for Egypt, we advise you to contact your mobile phone service provider to request an international data package so you can access your emails and WhatsApp or similar apps. **Remember: international roaming charges can be exorbitant.**

You could also ask for an international voice package. While this costs more than a data-only package, it is significantly cheaper than the bill you will receive if you make calls or receive calls while in Egypt, without an international package.

If you use data or make or receive international calls while in Egypt and do not have the appropriate international call/data packages, you will be shocked when you receive your telephone bill.

Other information that might be helpful as you prepare for your trip:

Country Profile

Egypt has over 100 million people, with a land area of just 386,102 square miles. Most of the population lives in Cairo, or along the Nile or the Mediterranean Coast.

With treasures as timeless as the Temples, Pyramids, and the magical Nile River, Egypt captivates all who visit. Most of the country's ancient treasures were built during the time of the pharaohs.

The Pyramids of Giza (the sole survivors of the Seven Ancient Wonders of the World); the lotus-columned temples of Luxor and Karnak; the Valley of the Kings; Aswan and the Temples of Abu Simbel: strung along the Nile, are monuments that represent the legacy of one of the most written and talked about periods of human history.

About 90% of Egypt's population is Muslim, with most of the remainder being Christian, including followers of the Coptic Christian faith. There is also a small Jewish population.

Ask permission when taking pictures of someone, especially women and be aware that some traditionally-dressed locals demand money when they 'pose' outside historic sites, especially temples and pyramids

Egypt is a developing country with a diversified economy, the largest in Africa, the 38th-largest economy in the world, by nominal GDP, and the 127th by nominal GDP per capita.

Egypt is a country with a reputation for being one of the friendliest in Africa. Egypt is divided into 27 administrative regions, known as governorates. Each governorate is headed by a governor who the President appoints. These governorates vary in size, population, and importance. Some include major cities like Cairo and Alexandria, while others cover vast desert areas.

With unspoiled beaches, natural attractions, and vibrant cosmopolitan cities, Egypt has rich ethnic diversity, abundant historical legacies, a strong cultural heritage, and ageless traditions. Visitors to Egypt can expect to be greeted by a sense of history and met with exceptional hospitality that has long been associated with its people.

Geography:

Egypt has coastlines on the Mediterranean Sea, the River Nile, and the Red Sea. Egypt borders



Libya to the west, Israel to the east, and Sudan to the south. It has an area of 387,050 square miles.

The longest straight-line distance in Egypt from north to south is 880 miles, while east to west measures 792 miles. Egypt has over 1,800 miles of coastline on the Mediterranean Sea, the Gulf of Suez, and the Gulf of Aqaba.

Egypt is the most populous country in the Arab world and the second-most populous on the African Continent. Its current population is over 116 million, with nearly 100% of the people living in Cairo and Alexandria or along the banks of the Nile.

Economy:

Egypt has natural resources, including petroleum and natural gas, iron ore, phosphates, manganese, limestone, gypsum, talc, asbestos, lead, and zinc. Approximately one-third of the Egyptian labor is directly engaged in farming or food processing.

Egypt is also a major producer of textiles, chemicals, petrochemicals, construction, iron, steel, aluminum, cement, and military equipment.

The Currency

The Egyptian Pound is the currency of Egypt. The Egyptian pound is abbreviated to EGP, E£, or in Arabic (م.ج). One Egyptian Pound is subdivided into smaller currency denominations known as piastres and millimes. 1 EGP = 100 piastres = 1000 millimes.

The pound-to-dollar exchange rate changes frequently. When you arrive in Egypt, you can exchange dollars for pounds at the prevailing rate. There is no limit on the cash you bring into

Egypt, but as stated previously, you must declare any amount over \$10,000. Lesser amounts do not need to be declared. There will be numerous opportunities for you to exchange your dollars for the Egyptian pound.

Language:

Although Standard Arabic is the official language in Egypt, citizens also speak English. Therefore, you should not have difficulty communicating with locals and thoroughly enjoying every aspect of your stay in Egypt.

Government

Egypt is a republic with a semi-presidential system. The President is the head of state, while the

Prime Minister is the head of government. Egypt's government is based on a combination of executive, legislative, and judicial branches, and elections are held for the President and Parliament.

Current President: President Abdel Fattah el-Sisi

Current Prime Minister: Mostafa Madbouly

History:

Egypt, one of the oldest civilizations in the world, dates to around 3100 BC when the ancient Egyptians established a powerful kingdom along the Nile River. Renowned for its iconic monuments, such as the Pyramids of Giza, the Sphinx, and the temples of Luxor, Egypt was a center of science, art, and culture in antiquity.

Over centuries, Egypt was ruled by various dynasties, including the Pharaonic, Greco-Roman, and Islamic periods. Today, Egypt's historical legacy continues to captivate visitors with its rich archaeological heritage.

Safety:

We want to reassure you that Egypt is a peaceful and secure travel destination despite the ongoing unrest in the region. We further wish to assure you that as of now, nothing regarding the conflicts in the area has impacted tour operations in Egypt.

While Egypt continues to welcome travelers worldwide without incident, no one knows what the future might hold. We therefore strongly recommend that all tour members buy travel insurance. This will provide an extra layer of security and peace of mind and ensure you are covered in the unlikely event of any unexpected circumstance.

As stated above, our company offers travel insurance through Allianz Travel. Click the link below for a no-obligation quote:

<https://www.africanconnections-usa.com/travelinsurance.html>

Further, our company's usual cancellation policy is as follows:

Cancellation Fee Schedule

- A \$250 per person fee will apply to all cancellations, and that is the only fee applicable if the cancellation is more than 90 days prior to the scheduled departure date.
- 90-61 days prior to scheduled departure is 25% of the trip price



- 60-46 days before scheduled departure is 50% of the trip price
- 45-0 days before scheduled departure is 100% of the trip price

However, we have added the following Addendum to our usual cancellation policy that only applies to our Egypt Tours:

“Your safety is our most important concern. Therefore, if 90 days from your scheduled departure date, African Connections determines that the situation on the ground in Egypt warrants the cancellation of the scheduled tour, African Connections will offer you a full refund of any amounts over \$500 that you have paid for this tour.”

We are confident that Egypt will continue to be a safe and tourist-friendly destination. Nevertheless, we are closely monitoring the situation and will keep you apprised.

Frequently Asked Questions for U.S. Tourists Visiting Egypt

General Travel Information

1. Do I need a visa to visit Egypt?

Yes, U.S. citizens need a visa to enter Egypt. You can obtain an e-Visa online before arrival or get a visa on arrival at Egyptian airports. Your passport must be valid for at least six months beyond your travel dates.

2. How can I apply for a visa?

You can apply for a visa online via the Egypt e-Visa Portal or upon arrival at Cairo Airport with entry visas cost of \$25. Check our website for the latest visa information and application links.

3. What vaccinations do I need before traveling?

Routine vaccines (MMR, hepatitis A & B, tetanus) are recommended. While not required, vaccines for typhoid and rabies are suggested for extended stays or rural travel.

4. Is Egypt safe for tourists?

Egypt is generally safe for tourists, especially in areas like Cairo, Luxor, and Aswan. However, travelers should stay aware of their surroundings, avoid protests, and use reputable tour operators.

5. What is the best time to visit Egypt?



March/April & Oct/Nov are great times to visit Egypt as it is not too hot. There is very little rainfall so we will enjoy clear skies and sunshine each day. Egypt's weather in October is excellent. In fact, October is one of the best months to travel to Egypt. During your visit to Egypt, the average daytime highs should range around 85°F, and nighttime temperatures should range from 68°F to 77°F.

6. What is the dress code at Egypt?

As most of the places we go are tourist areas the dress code is very casual. Dress for coolness and comfort but try to avoid anything too revealing or short especially when we visit local places like markets. For women It is best to pack a few pairs of long shorts or ¾ length lightweight pants, a selection of wash and wear shirts. Lightweight dresses if you prefer. Knee length or below is good. Take one lightweight jacket for late night or early morning. Scarf for church visit and a sarong over your swimmers in resorts. For Men: Long pants are required for visits to religious sites.

7. Is there a public toilet at the sites to be visited?

There are public toilets at the sites we visit. Most public toilets throughout the Middle East and Europe require payment to the cleaners so try to keep your smallest notes for this. Where possible use your hotel or the restaurants. Always carry a pack of tissues and hand sanitizer with you.

8. Is there an internet service?

We will have access to internet at each hotel, mainly in the foyers and it is free. There is no free access on board the cruise but we have a mobile device you can connect to if necessary.

9. Is it allowed to take photographs of people?

Ask permission when taking pictures of someone, especially women and be aware that some traditionally-dressed locals demand money when they 'pose' outside historic sites, especially temples and pyramids

10. What fitness level are we supposed to maintain?

A moderate level of fitness is required to enjoy all the sites we visit. Some of the days we are out and about all day but walking is always at a strolling pace as there is so much to see and take in. The stairs into and out of the pyramids and tombs are the most strenuous part of the trip, so just take your time.

11. What shoes should we wear?

Please make sure you take comfortable flat walking shoes as most of the sites have uneven ground, desert sand and rocks. Also take at least one pair with nonslip sole for entering pyramids and tombs. Egypt is not the place for high heels!

12. How is power supply at Egypt?

Don't forget all your chargers for camera, phone, I-Pad laptop etc. You will need a round 2 pin converter plug, same as used in Europe. Hairdryers are provided in all hotels and also on the Nile Cruise.

13. Can we take alcohol at Egypt?

Alcohol is available in the hotel bars and onboard in our Nile Cruise.

14. Is smoking allowed in Egypt?

Many Egyptian's smoke so expect it everywhere.

15. What food will be available during our tour visit in Egypt?

In the hotels we have a full buffet breakfast each day. Traditional Egyptian food like kofta, kebab sticks, mixed grill, koshari and felafel is readily available and you will never get bored with the choices. There are also plenty of varieties of vegetarian food available. The Nile Cruise includes breakfast lunch and dinner.

Money & Costs

16. What currency is used in Egypt?

The **Egyptian Pound (EGP)** is the official currency. Credit cards are widely accepted in major hotels and restaurants, but cash is recommended for markets and small vendors.

17. How much does a meal cost in Egypt?

A meal at a mid-range restaurant costs **\$15-\$20 per person**, while local street food or casual dining can be **\$5-\$10**.

18. Can I use U.S. dollars in Egypt?

While U.S. dollars may be accepted at some tourist locations, it's best to use Egyptian pounds or exchange your currency at banks or exchange offices. ATMs are widely available.

Transportation & Getting Around

19. Do I need an international driver's license to rent a car?

Yes, an **International Driving Permit (IDP)** is required, but driving in Egypt can be chaotic. Most tourists prefer hiring a driver or using taxis and rideshare apps like Uber and Careem.

20. Is public transportation safe?



Public transport, such as buses and minibuses, can be crowded and challenging for tourists. Taxis, Uber, and private tours are safer and more convenient.

Health & Safety

21. Is tap water safe to drink?

We will supply you with bottled water each day. It is also available in your hotel rooms. Although the locals all drink tap water it is very heavily chlorinated and is fine for brushing teeth and bathing, but is not recommended for drinking. The hotels, cruise ship and the restaurants that we select for you, all use purified water to make their ice cubes. So you should feel free to add ice cubes to your drinks.

22. Do I need travel insurance?

Yes, travel insurance is highly recommended for medical emergencies, lost luggage, and trip cancellations.

However, our company offers optional travel insurance through Allianz Global, a leader in the travel insurance field. You can click the link below or visit our website, www.africanconnections-usa.com, to get a quote.

https://www.agentmaxonline.com/agentmaxweb/widgets/quotetool.html?widgetid=859099&ac_cam=F212819&code=ABIYU4TLWGBGTNHC6ZWLRSKAR65GB6C5JLBJOIXR7QY3M6I5HDDHZDIECAM4JHS6KBOBIU5FYWBJM3BAHKTF TOR572B73AM4ZH74ZMNXVK3YLBWT3Z3F4X4R3Z53LEU4

23. Should we bring our own medicine?

Please remember to take enough prescribed medication for duration of the tour. Chemists are very easy to access and things such as anti-biotics are available over the counter at a very cheap price.

Activities

24. Can we have time for shopping?

You will love shopping in Egypt! Whether you are haggling for souvenirs at one of Egypt's traditional local markets, or shopping in one of its modern shops, Egypt has something for everyone!

Whether shopping for Egyptian cotton, Egyptian oils, silver jewelry, papyrus or alabaster, you will find great values, if you haggle.

Bargaining with the locals is not for the faint of heart, as vendors will follow you back to the bus if you show any interest at all so be prepared to walk away and stay firm with your price.

25. **Can one do personal purchases?**

Please allow a small daily budget, around USD\$15 for snacks, tea, coffee, soft drink (more if you enjoy a beer or wine or 2). Room service, spa treatments, laundry etc will also be at your own expense.

Prepare to be Amazed!

Beneath the glittering facade of modern Egypt is a country at the crossroads of the contemporary, the ancient, the indigenous, and the exotic. Egypt is unique and unforgettable! Have your cameras ready!

The African Connections Team is eagerly awaiting your arrival in Egypt and is ready to assist you as you prepare for your African Adventure!